Reconstruction of Black Hole Ringdown Signals with Data Gaps using a Deep-Learning Framework

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Data gaps near the onset of black hole ringdown can obscure much of its rapidly decaying signal. We present DenoiseGapFiller (DGF), a neural network that jointly denoises and reconstructs ringdown waveforms using complementary time–frequency and temporal representations. We evaluate DGF on 6,000 independent simulated LISA observations with gaps spanning approximately 6%–10% of each record. For network signal-to-noise ratios $\rho \geq 10$, the mean direct noise-weighted mismatch is 5.32×10^{-3} at fixed arrival time and phase. The corresponding mean over all 6,000 test signals is 8.52×10^{-3}. Across the full test population, mean absolute phase errors at the signal-envelope peak are below 4° in both A/E channels. These results demonstrate recovery of the oscillatory waveform across gaps, including intervals containing the signal peak, within the simulated source population and stationary Gaussian instrument-noise model.

I. INTRODUCTION

The ringdown following a binary black hole merger carries information about the remnant spacetime. In the perturbative regime, its waveform is described by damped quasinormal modes whose frequencies and decay times depend on the mass and spin of a Kerr black hole [1, 2]. Measuring these modes is the basis of black hole spectroscopy and ringdown tests of general relativity [3]. Space-based observatories such as LISA, Taiji and TianQin offer access to the ringdowns of massive black hole binaries in the millihertz band [4–7].

Ringdown amplitudes decay rapidly. An interruption near the onset can therefore remove a substantial fraction of the signal even when its duration is short compared with the analysis window. Scheduled interruptions and unscheduled data losses are relevant to space-based observations [8, 9]. Shi *et al.* [10] examined their effects on ringdown observability and parameter estimation. Multiplication by a gap window also redistributes power across Fourier frequencies [11]. The reconstruction problem consequently concerns the phase and decay envelope across the gap, as well as the complete waveform. Gaps covering as much as 20% of a short ringdown record illustrate the severity of this problem. Here we study gaps spanning approximately 6%–10% of a 528-s record.

Existing approaches exploit different information about the missing signal. Interpolation uses neighboring samples, with accuracy determined by the bandwidth, sampling and interpolation rule [12–14]. Bayesian data augmentation treats missing samples as latent variables in source-parameter inference [8]. Sparse representations provide a basis for inpainting [15]; Fourier sparsity has been used to recover Galactic-binary signals in gapped LISA data [16]. Learned dictionaries provide another way to encode waveform structure for denoising [17]. Ringdown reconstruction poses a specific challenge for these approaches: the waveform is oscillatory, its envelope changes rapidly, and the available context can be strongly asymmetric about the gap.

Neural methods learn reconstruction maps from simulated waveforms and noisy observations. Xu *et al.* [18] used a DenseNet–BiLSTM model for inspiral–merger–ringdown signals under several forms of corruption. Mao *et al.* [19] combined a convolutional autoencoder with a bidirectional gated recurrent unit for long LISA sequences containing gaps. WaveFormer [20] combines convolutional feature extraction and Transformer blocks for denoising ground-based data, and assesses amplitude and phase recovery separately. Here we focus on short ringdown records, where a gap can cover the amplitude peak and leave substantially different signal strengths on its two sides.

We develop DGF to recover damped oscillations from noisy observations with a known gap. The time–frequency branch represents local oscillatory content through complex Morlet continuous wavelet transform (CWT) coefficients. The temporal branch preserves the sign and multiscale structure of the waveform. Mixing layers combine these complementary features, and sequence blocks connect context on both sides of the interval before a decoder synthesizes the clean waveform. Related time-series models use temporal and feature mixing to combine information across scales [21, 22]. Whitening uses a calibrated power spectral density (PSD), while mask-aware and joint-channel modules refine the decoded waveform. A coefficient head conditions a training-derived signal basis on the observed noise level and phase features.

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The observation model is $d = Gh+n$: G suppresses the signal over one interval, and noise is present throughout the record. We evaluate waveform mismatch at fixed arrival time and phase, together with amplitude residuals, error spectra and per-channel analytic phase. We report the accuracy for $\rho \geq 10$ alongside complete-population statistics, and examine recovery across gaps containing the signal-envelope peak.

Section II presents the reconstruction framework, signal and noise models, and training protocol. Section III evaluates waveform recovery, gap-location dependence, amplitude fidelity and phase accuracy. Section IV discusses the implications for ringdown analysis and the scope of the simulations. The appendixes give implementation and reproducibility details, fixed-duration gap tests and a comparison with a reference DGF configuration.

II. METHODOLOGY

We generate simulated ringdown observations using standard LISA response and noise models. DGF operates on the A/E time-delay interferometry (TDI) channels and estimates their complete clean waveforms from the observations and known gap mask. The signal, response, noise calibration and preprocessing described below are shared by the training, validation and independent test sets.

A. Physical ringdown signals and LISA response

The source population consists of nonspinning progenitor binaries. The source-frame total mass $M_{\rm tot}^{\rm src}$ is drawn log-uniformly from 10^5 to $5\times10^6\,M_\odot$, the light-to-heavy mass ratio $q = m_2/m_1$ uniformly from 0.3 to 1, and redshift z uniformly from 1 to 6. Sky position and inclination are isotropic; polarization and orbital phase are uniform on their angular ranges. We use a flat ΛCDM distance relation with $H_0 = 67.4\,\mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$ and $\Omega_m = 0.315$.

The SEOBNRv4 remnant prescription implemented in LALSimulation determines the source-frame remnant mass $M_f^{\rm src}$ and dimensionless spin χ_f. The Kerr-mode frequencies and damping times use the detector-frame remnant mass,

$$M_f^{\rm det} = (1+z)M_f^{\rm src}. \tag{1}$$

The fundamental modes $(\ell,m,n) = (2,2,0),(2,1,0),(3,3,0),(4,4,0)$ enter the PyCBC time-domain ringdown generator [1, 2, 23]. Spherical angular harmonics and luminosity-distance scaling specify the polarizations. Writing $q_\star = 1/q$, the mode excitation coefficients are [24]

$$\begin{aligned}
&\alpha_{22} = 0.25e^{-q_\star/7.5},\\
&\frac{\alpha_{21}}{\alpha_{22}} = 0.13(q_\star-1)^{1/2}, \qquad \frac{\alpha_{33}}{\alpha_{22}} = 0.18(q_\star-1)^{1/3},\\
&\frac{\alpha_{44}}{\alpha_{22}} = 0.024q_\star^{3/4}.
\end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

These fits refer to the reference epoch used by Kamaretsos *et al.*, ten remnant-mass time units after the dominant-mode luminosity peak. The relative phase convention is $\phi_{\ell m} = m\phi_{\rm orb}$. It defines a simplified coherent mode family for this reconstruction study. PyCBC's prereference exponential ring-up joins continuously to the damped-mode segment, whose excitation normalization is retained. The envelope has different one-sided slopes at the reference time. This onset convention and the delayed TDI combinations are retained in the reconstruction targets.

The polarizations are projected onto the constellation links with `fastlisaresponse` [25]. Delayed link combinations produce second-generation TDI X, Y, Z observables in an idealized equal-arm constellation. The analyzed channels are

$$A = \frac{Z-X}{\sqrt{2}}, \qquad E = \frac{X-2Y+Z}{\sqrt{6}}. \tag{3}$$

Both channels are expressed in fractional-frequency units. We generate the response on a padded parent sequence, remove the padding and select a 528-s analysis window. Reconstruction is evaluated on that finite window, including for signals whose damping times exceed its duration.

B. Instrument noise, calibration and whitening

Independent stationary Gaussian A/E instrument-noise realizations are generated from the second-generation TDI sensitivities provided by LISA Analysis Tools, with the `scirdv1` instrument model and no confusion foreground [26]. For an interior real-FFT bin, the independent real and imaginary noise quadratures have variance $N_p f_s S_c(f_k)/4$, where N_p is the padded parent length and $c \in \{A, E\}$. The inverse transform and padding removal give the simulated time series.

A fixed PSD $S_{c,\rm cal}(f_k)$ is estimated by averaging one-sided periodograms from 512 independent noise-only segments, each containing $N = 1056$ samples at $f_s = 2\,\mathrm{Hz}$. Estimating the PSD after cropping accounts for finite-window leakage near transfer-function nulls. The same calibration arrays define whitening, the training loss and the comparison metric for every model. The metric uses diagonal Fourier-bin weights. A likelihood for finite records additionally requires the corresponding noise covariance.

The observation is whitened by the invertible transformation

$$u_c = W_c d_c = \mathrm{irfft}\left[\frac{\mathrm{rfft}(d_c)_k}{\sqrt{f_s S_{c,\mathrm{cal}}(f_k)/2}}\right]. \tag{4}$$

At DC and Nyquist, positive neighboring-bin values define the whitening factors. Inverse whitening then restores the original fractional-frequency units. These two bins have zero weight in the primary overlap. The first 128 calibration segments determine the expected white-noise RMS, excluding DC and Nyquist, for the coefficient head. All calibration segments are independent of the signal population and test observations.

C. Analysis windows and data gaps

For each channel we use the observation and binary mask

$$d_{c,j} = G_j h_{c,j} + n_{c,j}, \qquad m_j = 1 - G_j, \tag{5}$$

where $G_j = 0$ inside the gap and $G_j = 1$ elsewhere. The supervised target is the complete clean A/E waveform $h_{c,j}$. Instrument noise remains present inside the interval. Masking is applied to the physical signal before whitening.

Gap widths are sampled uniformly from the 21 even integers $64, 66, \ldots, 104$, corresponding to 32–52 s or 6.06%–9.85% of the record. Changing the width preserves the reference interval center. Fixed widths of 66 and 100 samples provide additional duration checks. The parent response peak sets the event-centered simulation window, with reference gap offsets drawn between -66 and 66 s. This setup assumes that the event has already been localized in time. A second seeded draw places the reference interval start at local samples 132–263 and determines the crop. The network receives the resulting observation and known mask at inference.

D. Dual-branch DGF encoder and waveform synthesis

Figure 1 shows the DGF architecture. The two A/E channels share encoder weights. The time–frequency branch represents a complex Morlet CWT by its modulus and argument. Sixteen scales and a factor-four temporal subsampling give a $2\times16\times264$ array per channel. Mixing along the temporal, feature and scale axes, followed by convolutional embedding and linear projection, produces $8 \times 32 \times 64$ features.

A second Morlet CWT uses 16 logarithmically spaced frequencies from 0.002 to 0.25 Hz. Three convolutional stages with group normalization and GELU map these low-frequency features to an additive correction before the time–frequency branch projection.

The temporal branch subtracts the observed mean, divides by the observed standard deviation and computes a db4 decomposition. Eight reconstructed subbands preserve signed time-domain information. Each is divided into 32 overlapping patches of 64 samples with stride 32, giving the same $8 \times 32 \times 64$ feature shape. The relation $1056 = 64 + 31 \times 32$ fixes the input length.

The branch features are added and passed through token, convolutional and sinusoidal position embeddings. A residual Conv2d layer precedes 16 sequence blocks, each containing channel-wise scaled dot-product attention, normalization and a feedforward layer. The decoder maps features to waveform patches, averages overlapping samples, sums the subbands and applies a Conv1d layer. Restoring the observation normalization gives the channel prediction. Appendix A specifies the attention operation and numerical implementation.

E. Joint-channel refinement and noise-conditioned coefficients

A channel-wise mask-aware residual module receives the observation, intermediate prediction, mask and normalized time coordinate. Its six dilated Conv1d blocks have width 24, kernel size 7 and dilations $1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32$, with group normalization and GELU. A second width-32 residual module couples the A and E predictions using the same dilation schedule.

We construct a joint basis $B \in \mathbb{R}^{2N\times128}$ from the 60,000 clean training waveforms in whitened coordinates. After removing DC and Nyquist, each waveform is normalized to give equal weight to each source. The leading eigenvectors of the resulting second-moment matrix form the basis. The basis and coefficient adapter produce the whitened prediction b.

The coefficient head predicts the waveform coordinates through

$$\begin{aligned} c_0 &= B^{\mathsf{T}} P_0 b, \qquad c = c_0 + 0.1 s \tanh F_\psi(z), \\ \widehat{u} &= Bc + (I - P_0)b, \qquad \widehat{h} = W^{-1}\widehat{u}. \end{aligned} \tag{6}$$

The operator P_0 removes DC and Nyquist in each channel. The scale $s = \mathrm{RMS}(u)\sqrt{2N}$ uses a small RMS floor for numerical stability. Equation (6) preserves the endpoint components of b. With a zero-initialized final layer, the head reproduces the starting coefficient prediction to floating-point precision.

The 470-dimensional input z contains 262 normalized waveform, coefficient and mask coordinates; 16 absolute-noise and spectral-energy features; and 192 pooled continuous-phase features. The noise features use endpoint-excluded observed RMS, the independently calibrated noise RMS, coarse observed frequency-band energy ratios and RMS residuals between observation and prediction. For the physical-frequency CWT, continuous

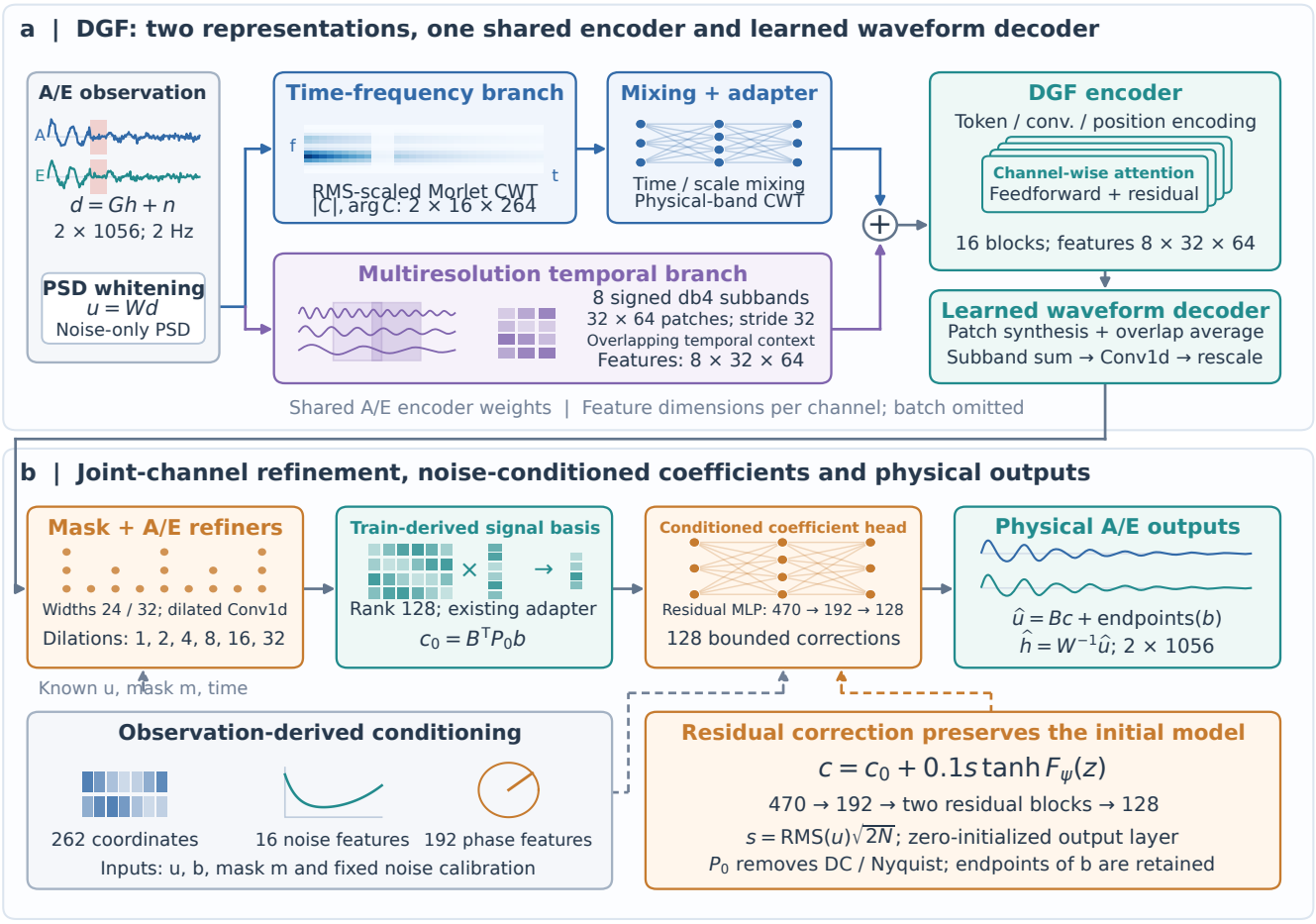


FIG. 1. DGF architecture. (a) The two channels share weights in the time–frequency and temporal branches, whose features are fused before encoding and waveform synthesis. (b) Mask-aware and joint-channel refiners feed a signal-basis adapter and noise-conditioned coefficient head. P_0 removes DC and Nyquist; the endpoint components of the intermediate prediction are restored before inverse whitening. Solid arrows mark the main path and dashed arrows mark conditioning inputs. Feature dimensions are per A/E channel, with the batch dimension omitted. The small waveform, transform and network drawings are schematic.

phase is encoded as

$$a_C\{1, \cos\theta_C, \sin\theta_C\}, \quad a_C = \log(1+|C|), \quad \theta_C = \arg C. \tag{7}$$

Amplitude weighting makes the phase features approach zero as the local CWT amplitude approaches zero. Pooling these features to a 4×8 grid in each channel gives 192 entries. The head maps 470 inputs to width 192, applies two residual multilayer perceptron (MLP) blocks and outputs 128 coefficients. Each residual block uses layer normalization, two linear layers, GELU and dropout 0.05. The coefficient head has 264,128 parameters. The complete stored model has 9,589,685 parameters.

At inference, the coefficient head uses only the observation, current prediction, known mask and fixed noise calibration. Source parameters and clean targets enter simulation, training supervision and evaluation.

F. Training objective and data partition

We define the direct joint-channel inner product by

$$(a|b)_S = 4\Delta f\, \mathrm{Re} \sum_{c\in\{A,E\}} \sum_{k=1}^{N/2-1} \frac{\widetilde{a}_{c,k}\widetilde{b}^*_{c,k}}{S_{c,\mathrm{cal}}(f_k)}, \tag{8}$$

where $\widetilde{a} = \Delta t\ \mathrm{rfft}(a)$, $\Delta t = 1/f_s$ and $\Delta f = f_s/N$. The joint-channel mismatch and optimal network signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) are

$$\mathcal{M}_{AE} = 1 - \frac{(h|\widehat{h})_S}{\sqrt{(h|h)_S(\widehat{h}|\widehat{h})_S}}, \quad \rho^2 = (h|h)_S. \tag{9}$$

We evaluate the overlap at the original time and phase. For nonzero waveforms, $\mathcal{M}_{AE} \in [0,2]$, with values above one for anticorrelated predictions. An overall positive

rescaling of the PSD cancels in the normalized overlap; its frequency dependence sets the relative bin weights.

The two-channel training objective is

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{M}_{AE} + 0.2E_S + 0.02E_{\rm time,gap}, \tag{10}$$

with

$$E_S = \frac{(\widehat{h}-h|\widehat{h}-h)_S}{(h|h)_S},$$
$$E_{\rm time,gap} = \frac{\sum_{c,j}(1+2m_j)(\widehat{h}_{c,j}-h_{c,j})^2}{\sum_{c,j}h_{c,j}^2}. \tag{11}$$

The objective combines waveform agreement, a noise-weighted amplitude residual and a time-domain residual with three times the weight inside the gap. Losses and population mismatches are arithmetic means over sources.

Figure 2 summarizes the training protocol. The training set contains 60,000 distinct physical sources. Each source contributes two variable-width observations and one fixed 33-s observation with an additional independent noise realization. Selected views undergo a global sign reversal of both observation and target. CWT and db4 features are recomputed for each view. One epoch contains 180,000 observations.

The validation set contains 1,500 independent sources. Model selection uses the mean direct mismatch over this complete set with uniformly sampled variable gap widths. Fixed 33- and 50-s gaps provide additional checks on the same sources. The independent test set contains 6,000 sources generated after model selection. Population summaries include all generated sources; SNR-conditioned summaries state the corresponding sample counts.

G. Training protocol

The encoder and waveform synthesis modules inherit a pretrained DGF checkpoint; the new coefficient head has a zero-initialized output layer. The initialization checkpoint and fixed preprocessing assets are identified by SHA-256 hashes in the archived training record. Optimization of this estimator proceeds in two stages. First, the coefficient head is trained with the encoder and waveform synthesis modules held fixed. Backbone predictions and observation features are cached for this stage. AdamW uses batches of 1024, weight decay 3×10^{-4} and a five-epoch warmup to learning rate 3×10^{-4}. The learning rate is halved on a validation plateau. Training has a maximum of 600 epochs, minimum 100, patience 100 and improvement threshold 10^{-6}.

The second stage jointly trains the decoder, physical-frequency adapter, channel-wise and joint residual modules, coefficient adapter and head. The encoder, transforms and signal basis remain fixed. This stage has 422,151 trainable parameters. Group learning rates range from 5×10^{-7} for the decoder to 10^{-4} for the head. It uses batches of 128, the same weight decay, a maximum of 200 epochs, minimum 40 and patience 50. Validation plateaus trigger further learning-rate reductions.

Raw and exponential-moving-average weights, with decay factor 0.995, are evaluated using the complete validation mean. Model selection, early stopping and learning-rate scheduling use validation sources. The independent test set is reserved for the selected estimator. Appendix A gives the numerical conventions, and Appendix B reports supplementary evaluation on the same independent test sources.

III. RECONSTRUCTION RESULTS

We evaluate the validation-selected checkpoint on 6,000 independent LISA test sources. Each 528-s record contains 1056 samples at 2 Hz and one 32–52-s gap drawn as specified in Sec. II C. We first report the $\rho \geq 10$ population, which contains 5814 sources, together with statistics for the full test set. The distributions include all 6,000 sources. The fixed-duration tests in Appendix B use the same source waveforms and noise realizations.

A. Waveform mismatch

We evaluate the noise-weighted mismatch in Eq. (9) jointly over the A/E channels at the injected time and phase. The corresponding time-domain mismatch is

$$\mathcal{M}_t = 1 - \frac{\sum_{c,j}h_{c,j}\widehat{h}_{c,j}}{\sqrt{\sum_{c,j}h_{c,j}^2\sum_{c,j}\widehat{h}_{c,j}^2}}. \tag{12}$$

These normalized overlaps measure waveform agreement. Population means assign equal weight to each source. We report amplitude-sensitive residuals separately in Sec. III D.

For $\rho \geq 10$, DGF achieves a mean direct noise-weighted mismatch of 0.00532, a median of 0.00241 and a 95th percentile of 0.01970 (Table I). These values quantify recovery at the original arrival time and phase. The full 6,000-source population has mean 0.00852, median 0.00254 and 95th percentile 0.02782. Figure 3 shows its complete mismatch distributions. Network SNR spans 1.69–923.52, with median 54.77; Fig. 4 shows the dependence on SNR and gap location.

B. Gap location and waveform recovery

We characterize gap location using the peak of the joint analytic envelope $[\sum_c |h_c + i\mathcal{H}[h_c]|^2]^{1/2}$, where $\mathcal{H}$ denotes the Hilbert transform. In the full test population, the peak lies inside the gap for 1935 sources. Their mean noise-weighted mismatch is 0.00912, with median 0.00285. For the remaining 4065 sources, the mean is

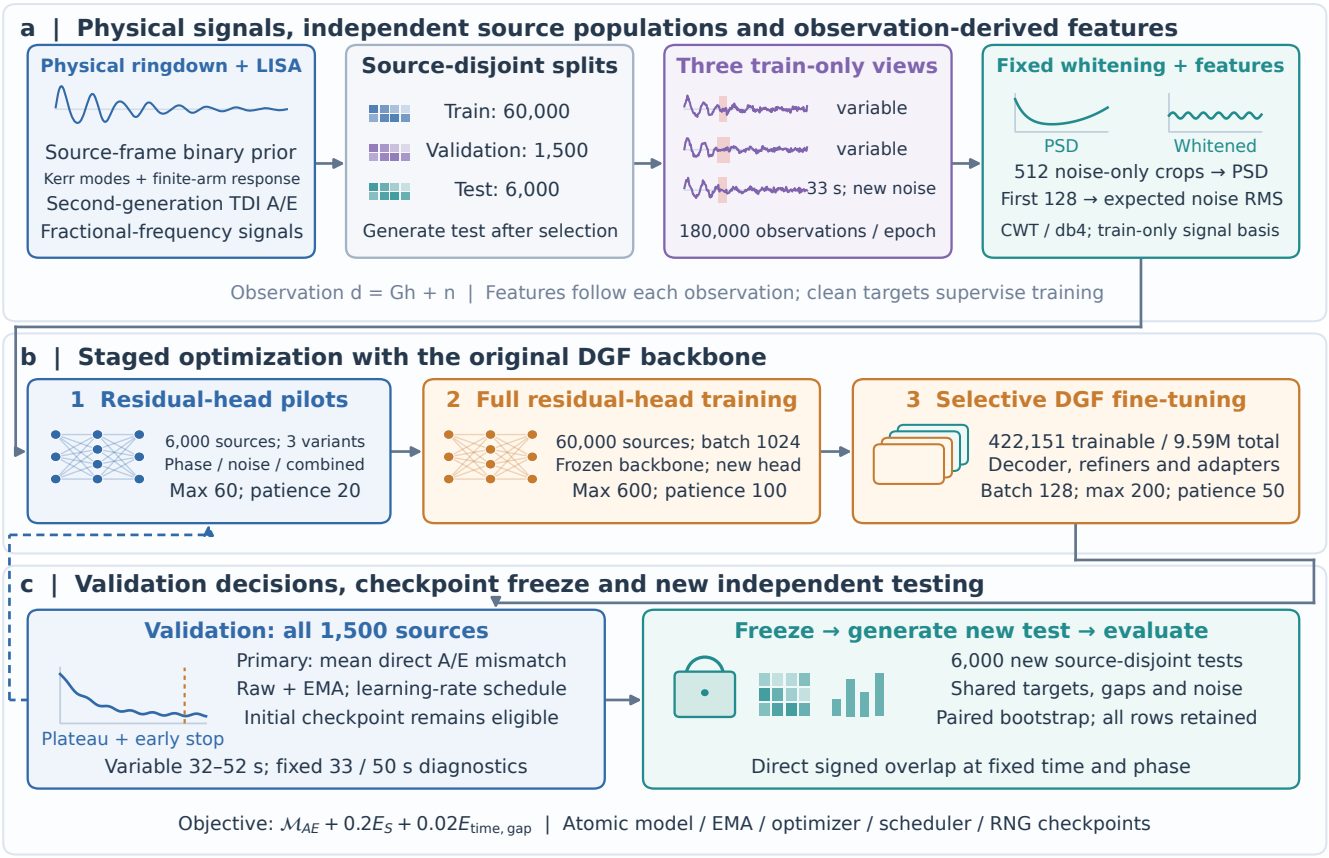


FIG. 2. LISA A/E simulation and training. Training, validation and test sources are disjoint. Augmentation uses training sources only; the signal basis is fitted to clean training waveforms, and whitening is calibrated on independent noise. Head selection and staged optimization use the full validation mean. The test observations are generated after the model and protocol are fixed. Dashed arrows indicate validation feedback. Epoch counts are stopping limits, and the small waveform, spectrum and optimization drawings are schematic.

TABLE I. DGF reconstruction accuracy for the independent variable-gap test. The first row gives the 5814 sources with network SNR $\rho \geq 10$; the second includes all 6,000 test sources. The overlap is evaluated at the injected time and phase.

Population	n	Mean $\mathcal{M}_{AE}$	Median $\mathcal{M}_{AE}$	95th percentile $\mathcal{M}_{AE}$	Mean $\mathcal{M}_t$
$\rho \geq 10$	5814	0.00532	0.00241	0.01970	0.00934
All test signals	6000	0.00852	0.00254	0.02782	0.01367

0.00823. These conditional statistics include the source and noise variations within each group.

Figure 5 shows two $\rho \geq 10$ sources reconstructed across 36- and 45-s gaps, with noise-weighted mismatches 5.59×10^{-4} and 6.07×10^{-4}. The gaps contain 42.7% and 56.8% of the respective joint signal squared norms. Their gap-local relative errors are 4.6% and 3.7%, and both channels retain the decaying oscillations through the missing intervals. For these two sources, the windows extend for approximately 4.9 dominant-mode damping times after the response peak.

C. Phase recovery

For each channel, define $z_c = h_c + i\mathcal{H}[h_c]$ and $\widehat{z}_c = \widehat{h}_c + i\mathcal{H}[\widehat{h}_c]$. At the clean-signal envelope peak $j_{\star,c}$, the phase error is

$$\Delta\phi_c = \arg[\widehat{z}_{c,j_{\star,c}} z^*_{c,j_{\star,c}}]. \tag{13}$$

Across all 6,000 test sources, the mean absolute phase errors are 3.84° in A and 3.79° in E. The corresponding medians are 2.19° and 2.14°, and the 95th percentiles are 12.72° and 11.58°. These statistics describe the analytic phase of each channel at its clean-signal envelope peak. Phase evolution through the resolved oscillations is shown in Fig. 6(b). Individual quasinormal-mode phases

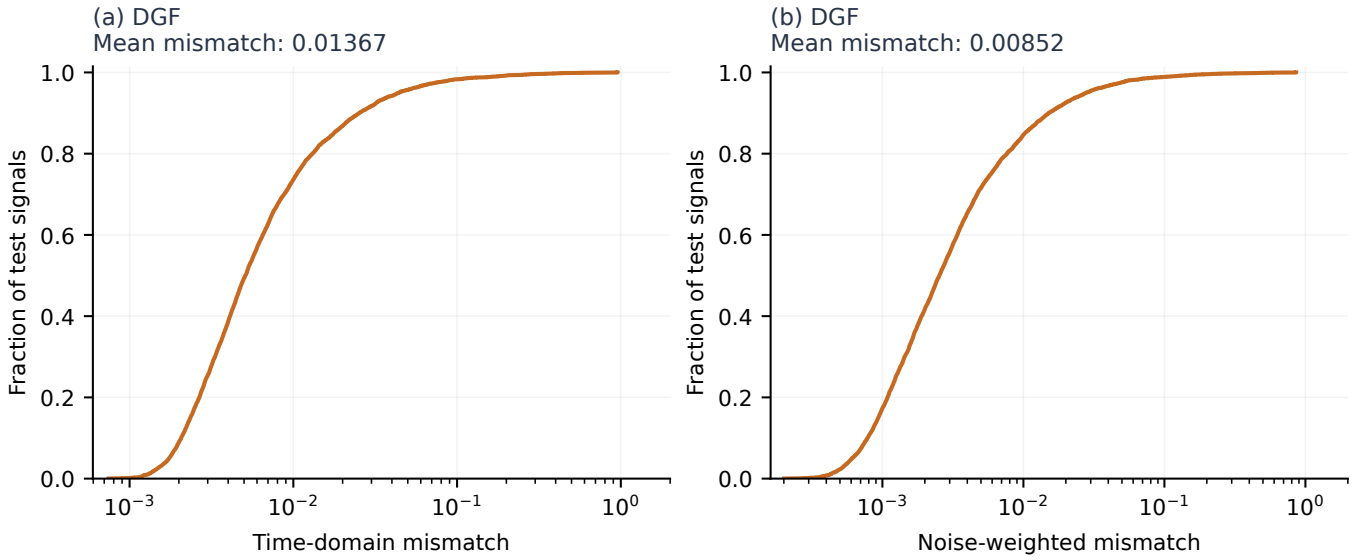


FIG. 3. Empirical distributions of time-domain and noise-weighted mismatch for all 6,000 independent test signals. The logarithmic axes show the full range of reconstruction errors. Both metrics use the original signal time and phase.

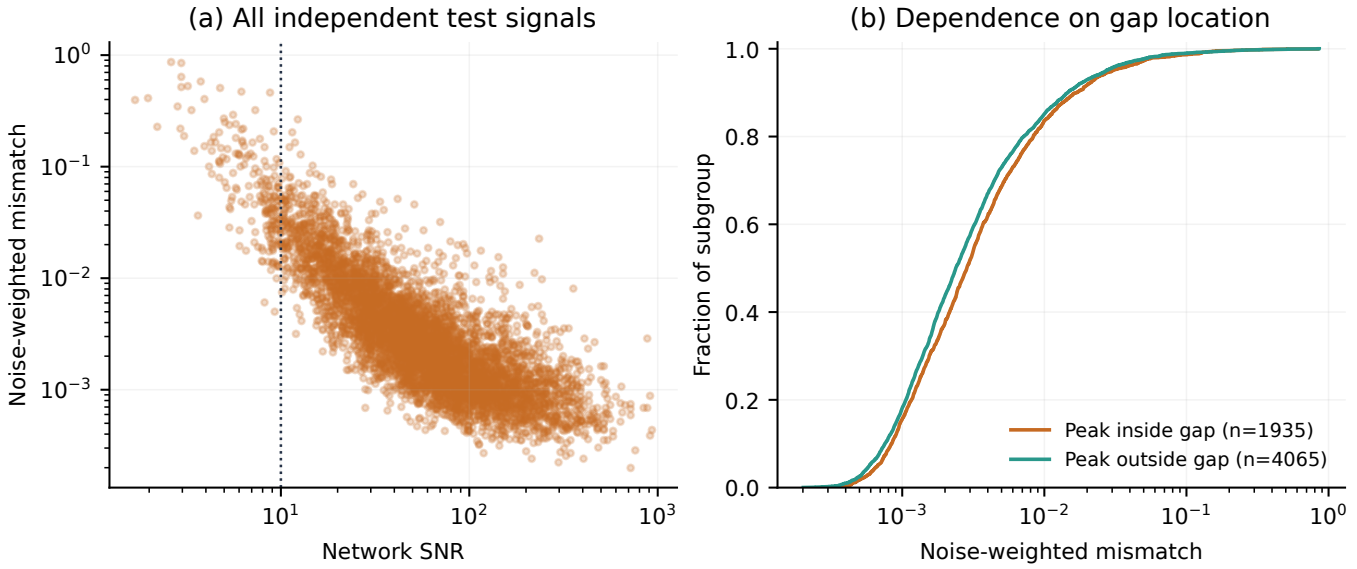


FIG. 4. Dependence of reconstruction accuracy on network SNR and gap location for the independent test population. (a) Joint noise-weighted mismatch versus network SNR, with the dotted line at $\rho = 10$. (b) Conditional mismatch distributions according to whether the joint signal-envelope peak falls inside the gap. All sources contribute to the complete-population statistics.

require a separate mode decomposition.

D. Amplitude and spectral fidelity

Normalized overlap is invariant under positive amplitude rescaling. We therefore evaluate the relative waveform error

$$E = \frac{\left[\sum_{c,j}(\widehat{h}_{c,j} - h_{c,j})^2\right]^{1/2}}{\left[\sum_{c,j} h_{c,j}^2\right]^{1/2}}. \tag{14}$$

Across all 6,000 test sources, E has mean 0.13424, median 0.10337 and 95th percentile 0.30008. The mean signed norm bias, $\|\widehat{h}\|_2/\|h\|_2 - 1$, is -0.01301. The norm bias measures overall amplitude scaling, while E also includes errors in waveform shape.

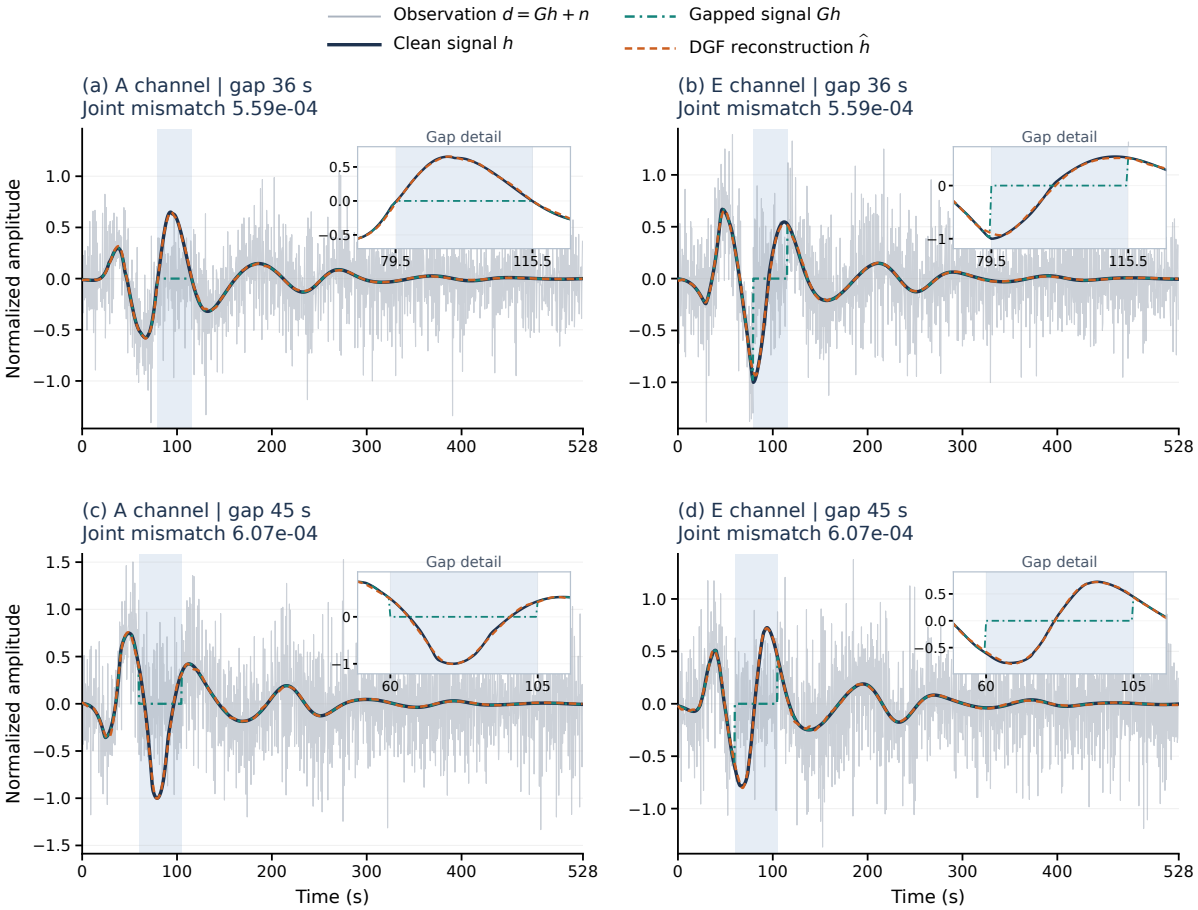


FIG. 5. Waveform reconstruction for two $\rho \geq 10$ sources across 36- and 45-s gaps in the A (left) and E (right) channels. Each panel superposes the noisy observation $d = Gh + n$ (gray), clean signal h, gapped clean signal Gh and DGF reconstruction $\widehat{h}$ over the full 528-s record; insets resolve the gap. Shading marks signal suppression, with noise retained. All four curves use the same clean-signal amplitude normalization per source and connect the original 0.5-s samples. Source seeds, from top to bottom, are 2038202231 and 2038201952. Full-population statistics use all 6,000 test sources.

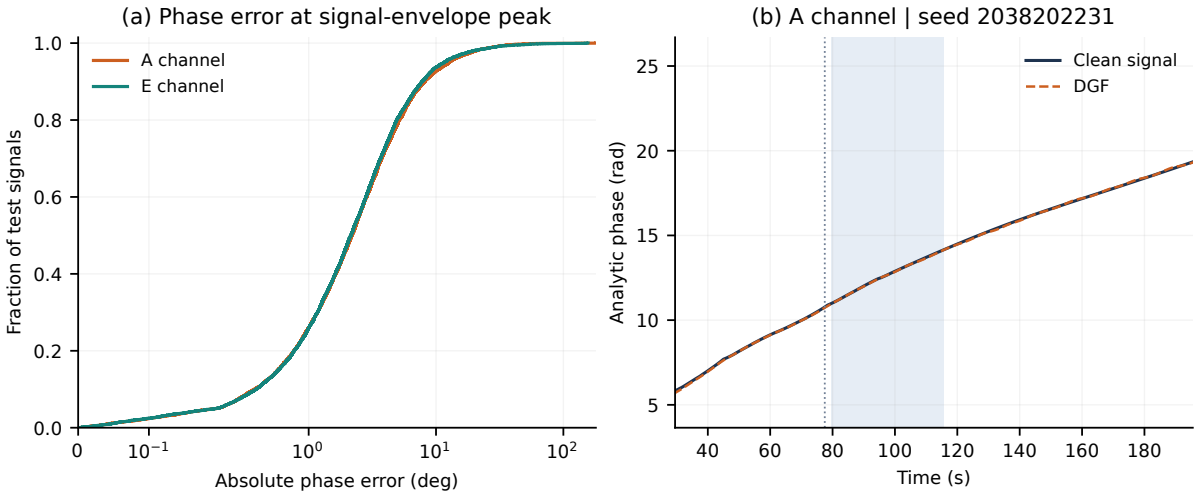


FIG. 6. (a) Absolute phase-error distributions for all 6,000 sources in each channel. (b) Analytic phase of the A channel for source 2038202231, also shown in Fig. 5(a). The displayed clean-signal envelope exceeds 10% of its peak. The common unwrapped phase branch preserves the relative phase modulo 2π; the arrival time and phase remain fixed. Shading marks the gap and the dotted line marks the clean envelope peak.

For the 1935 sources with envelope peaks inside the gap, the gap-local relative error $\|m(\widehat{h}-h)\|_2/\|mh\|_2$ has mean 0.13552 and median 0.10337. The denominator measures the clean signal contained within the interval. The full-waveform error E remains the common amplitude-sensitive measure for all sources.

Figures 7 and 8 show the logarithmic waveform amplitudes and population-averaged residual spectra, respectively. The amplitude panels use the sources in Fig. 5. The logarithmic scale reveals differences in the weak tail and near zero crossings that are less visible in the signed waveform plots. Tail-relative residuals grow as the clean envelope decays; the full-record overlap and the peak-phase statistic emphasize different parts of this structure.

IV. DISCUSSION AND CONCLUSIONS

DGF reconstructs black hole ringdown waveforms by combining time–frequency information with signed multiscale temporal features. A shared encoder and joint-channel refinement recover the clean LISA A/E waveforms from the noisy observation and gap mask. For the 5814 test sources with $\rho \geq 10$ and 32–52-s gaps, the mean direct noise-weighted mismatch is 0.00532. The mean over all 6,000 independent sources is 0.00852. The waveform comparisons show recovery of the decaying oscillations across intervals containing the signal peak, while amplitude residuals complement the normalized overlap.

For the full test population, the mean absolute analytic-phase errors at the envelope peak are 3.84° and 3.79° in A and E. Weak late-time oscillations contribute less to the full-record metrics and retain larger relative discrepancies, as the logarithmic amplitude plots illustrate. Assessing individual mode frequencies, damping times and phases requires mode-resolved fits over specified time intervals. The fixed-duration tests and reference comparison in Appendix B complement the variable-gap results; comparisons with other estimators on identical observations would establish their relative reconstruction accuracy.

The simulations cover nonspinning progenitor binaries, an idealized equal-arm constellation and stationary Gaussian instrument noise. They assume an event-centered window, one known gap and the signal history specified in Sec. II A. Tests with continuous merger histories would assess sensitivity to the pre-reference ringup entering the TDI delays. Moving unequal-arm constellations, confusion foregrounds, nonstationary noise, overlapping sources and multiple gaps require simulations spanning those conditions.

DGF provides a clean-waveform point estimate for inspecting ringdown structure and initializing waveform fits. Parameter inference uses the original observation likelihood, constructed from $d - Gh(\theta)$ and the noise covariance. Posterior bias and coverage tests would establish the accuracy of that inference, including for gaps near the signal peak. Previous LISA gap studies [8, 19] motivate this validation alongside waveform-level metrics. Quantifying reconstruction uncertainty and testing the recovery of individual modes are the next steps toward applications in black hole spectroscopy.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

The authors thank He Wang and Yiyang Guo for helpful discussions. This research is supported in part by the National Key R&D Program of China, grant number 2020YFC2201300, and the National Natural Science Foundation of China, grant numbers 12035016, 12375058 and 12361141825.

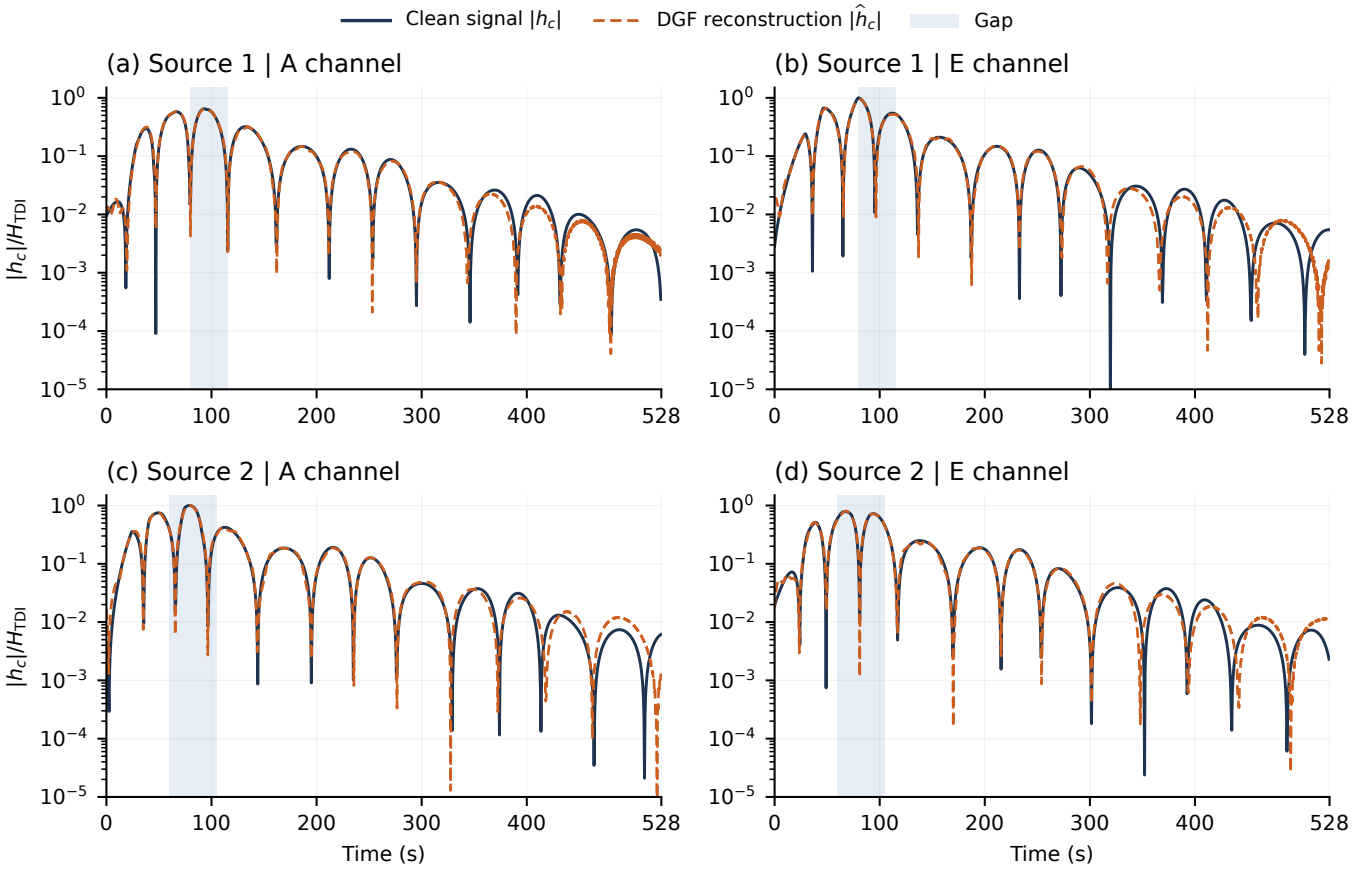


FIG. 7. Absolute amplitudes of the clean and reconstructed A (left) and E (right) waveforms for the sources in Fig. 5. Each row uses the common scale $H_{\mathrm{TDI}} = \max_{c,j} |h_{c,j}|$ from the clean signal. Shading marks the gap. The logarithmic axis resolves small-amplitude structure and differences near zero crossings. All curves use the same physical-time arrays as Fig. 5, with native sampling and fixed arrival time and phase.

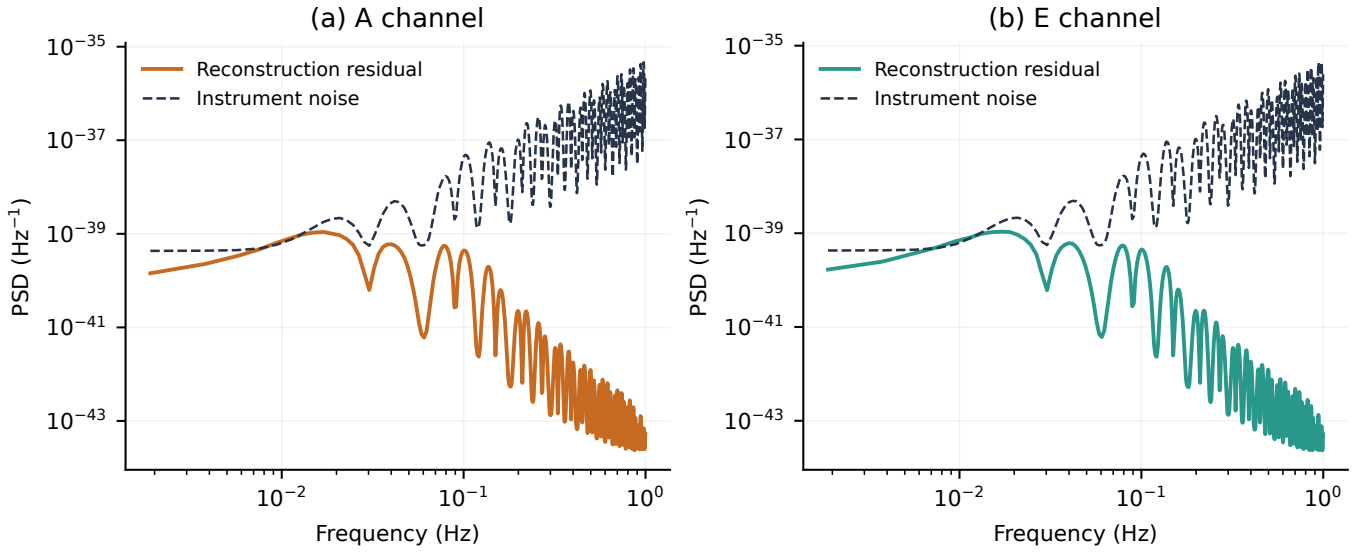


FIG. 8. Mean residual and noise power spectral densities in the A/E channels over all 6,000 test sources. The reconstruction residual is $\widehat{h} - h$. Fractional-frequency amplitudes are dimensionless, so the PSD has units Hz^{-1}. The curves use the same one-sided periodogram convention.

Appendix A: Implementation and reproducibility

1. Representations and attention

For each A/E channel, the backbone CWT array has shape $2 \times 16 \times 264$, and the temporal patches and fused features have shape $8 \times 32 \times 64$. For a feature matrix $Z \in \mathbb{R}^{32\times64}$, attention is computed as

$$A(Z) = \mathrm{softmax}(ZZ^{\mathsf{T}}/\sqrt{64})Z. \tag{A1}$$

Each of the eight feature channels applies this operation, followed by feedforward transformations, residual connections and normalization. The stored parameter count includes unused multihead-attention tensors allocated by the implementation. Attention spans the full sequence.

The db4 representation uses the approximation and seven detail components in library coefficient order. The decoder combines reconstructed patches by overlap averaging and subband summation. Its linear patch map and the encoder embedding map have independent checkpoint values. When loading, we clone the initially transposed storage before reading the tensors so that their saved values are preserved on both CPU and GPU.

2. Numerical and test conventions

The RMS floor in whitened coordinates is 10^{-4} for coefficient and residual normalization. Training spectral target and prediction squared norms are floored at 10^{-12} for finite numerical division, and physical-time relative-error denominators use the same floor in the scaled working representation. Physical evaluation uses float64 transforms, the common frozen PSD and the complete target norm. Overlap is clipped to $[-1, 1]$ to bound roundoff. A zero prediction is assigned mismatch one; a zero target triggers a dataset validation failure.

The A/E test seeds are 2038200000–2038205999. The additional fixed-gap training-noise seeds are 2158200000–2158259999. Features are recomputed from each generated observation. The reproducibility record contains raw and EMA checkpoints, training histories, noise calibration, masks, seeds and per-source predictions. SHA-256 manifests identify the source files and fixed assets. Restarting resumes the last completed epoch with its optimizer, scheduler and random-number states.

The simulated response peak determines the event-centered crop and gap metadata. Inference uses the cropped observation, known mask and fixed preprocessing arrays. Clean targets are used in the losses and evaluation. Configurations, source seeds and frozen checkpoint identifiers are included in the evaluation record. The project repository is https://github.com/ljq2088/RingdownGapFilling.

The two sources in Fig. 5 have envelope peaks inside the gap, $\rho \geq 10$ and records extending for at least four τ_{220} after the joint response peak. Their global and gap-local relative errors are below 6%, and their per-channel peak phase errors are below 2.5°. The archived figure arrays contain the source seeds, waveform parameters and per-source diagnostics.

TABLE II. Additional gap-duration tests on the same independent sources. For each duration, the $\rho \geq 10$ row contains 5814 sources and the complete-population row contains all 6,000 sources.

Gap and SNR	Mean $\mathcal{M}_{AE}$	Median $\mathcal{M}_{AE}$	95th percentile
33 s / $\rho \geq 10$	0.00438	0.00195	0.01608
33 s / all	0.00716	0.00204	0.02389
50 s / $\rho \geq 10$	0.00715	0.00334	0.02498
50 s / all	0.01112	0.00350	0.03653

The phase statistics in Sec. III C contain one value per channel for each of the 6,000 test sources. In intervals containing very little clean signal, gap-local normalization by $\|mh\|_2$ magnifies residuals. The complete-population amplitude diagnostic uses the full target norm, while the main-text gap-local statistic is reported for sources whose joint envelope peaks are inside the interval.

Appendix B: Fixed-duration gaps and reference comparison

We evaluate 33- and 50-s gaps on the same 6,000 source waveforms and noise realizations, preserving each gap's center. Table II reports both the $\rho \geq 10$ and full-population results. For $\rho \geq 10$, the mean joint noise-weighted mismatches are 0.00438 and 0.00715 for 33- and 50-s gaps, respectively. These tests vary the mask while holding the physical sources and noise fixed.

A reference DGF configuration with joint-channel synthesis and the training-derived signal basis is evaluated on the identical test observations. It uses the preceding fitted synthesis parameters and omits the final noise-conditioned head. For variable gaps across all 6,000 test sources, its mean mismatch is 0.00868, compared with 0.00852 for the selected model. The paired mean difference is -1.61×10^{-4}, with 95% bootstrap interval $[-2.45 \times 10^{-4}, -8.11 \times 10^{-5}]$. The interval uses 5,000 paired resamples of the independent test sources. This comparison concerns the complete fitted configurations, including their synthesis parameters and coefficient heads.

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